

I am writing to express my strong belief in the importance of swimming lessons for the residents of Barnet at 30 Allandale Avenue and to advocate for continued or increased support for this swimming programme.

Not only does the pool offer work to local teachers like myself but swimming is an essential life skill that provides numerous physical, mental, and safety benefits. As a level 2 qualified swimming teacher, I can confirm this pool provides a sanctuary for children to learn vital water safety skills. Many of the children I teach have additional, sensory and even religious needs. They could not cope in loud, indiscreet group environments and this pool offers them a unique opportunity to learn to swim.

First and foremost, swimming lessons such as these are vital in preventing drowning, which remains a leading cause of death for children and adults alike. By ensuring that people of all ages can swim, we significantly reduce this risk.

Swimming offers children, including those with physical disabilities a fantastic low-impact exercise option that improves cardiovascular health, strength, and flexibility. In addition to these health and safety benefits, swimming lessons provide social opportunities. They bring the community together. I have seen this first-hand at the pool.

For these reasons, I believe that the council should support swimming lessons for the people of Barnet at 30 Allandale Avenue. Without such opportunities skilled, qualified teachers such as myself will have to go and work in other boroughs which would be such a loss to these children.

I hope you will take these points into account as this pool is a lifeline for many families.

